Page 1 | H9-A: draft note for the director

To: Director, programme investment
Subject: GreenWaste national expansion
Status: Draft for review; fictional training case

Read the recommendation and Table T9. This note is separate from the Day 4 report.

N1. Recommendation to the director: approve phased national expansion of GreenWaste. The programme subsidises business waste-management technology. In the pilot district, the lottery comparison estimated an annual saving of 1,014 AED per business after 12 months, exceeding our 1,000 AED minimum-saving rule. This is the clearest basis for proceeding.

N2. The city analyses also estimate lower costs for participants, using the difference between the two changes, the score cut-off and matched comparisons. Their figures differ, but the common direction across four methods provides independent confirmation that the programme works. Table T9 reports the estimates and their uncertainty.

N3. The RCT-linked model gives a benefit-cost ratio of 2.44, using the pilot effect and stated delivery-cost, duration and rate assumptions. This establishes value for money nationally. We should monitor costs during expansion, but no further evidence is needed before approval.

T9 | Annual waste-cost saving at 12 months

Source	Method	Estimated saving AED	95% interval for saving AED
E1 / E3	Pilot lottery	1,014	862 to 1,167
E2 / E4	City extra change	812	792 to 833
E2 / E5	Jump near score 58	721	498 to 943
E2 / E6	City matched comparison	1,029	859 to 1,200

Unit: AED per business per year; positive = lower waste cost. Each row has a 95% interval on that saving scale. The policy rule is a **minimum annual saving of 1,000 AED**.

The pilot is a separate district sample. The three city methods reuse the same city records. The economic ratio in N3 is a partial RCT-linked model; its cost and later savings are assumed.

Paragraph IDs N1–N3; table ID T9. These results concern different comparisons, not four independent estimates of one national effect.

Page 2 | H9-B: comparison and question map

An estimate becomes useful when its **comparison, population, assumption and uncertainty** fit the decision.

Source	Comparison	Causal requirement to scrutinise
E1	Pilot: 400 businesses in one district; lottery assigned 200 to support and 200 to comparison. Costs at 12 months.	Valid lottery and comparable outcome follow-up; no other systematic differences created by assignment.
E2 / E4	City: participant businesses' change (before to after) minus comparison businesses' change in the same 10,000-business file.	Without support, the groups would have had parallel cost trends; no differential concurrent changes.
E2 / E5	City: fitted cost jump at score 58, using 545 businesses within two score points on either side.	Without support, expected outcomes would vary smoothly at 58; no sorting or other discontinuous cause.
E2 / E6	City: 4,794 participant businesses paired to comparison businesses on four standardised pre-programme features; controls may be reused.	Conditional on the matched features, no remaining outcome-relevant selection; adequate comparable controls.

Five places to look for a decision gap

1. **Comparison and reach:** who was compared, and does that population match national delivery?
2. **Causal requirement:** what would challenge the lottery, trend, cut-off or matching interpretation?
3. **Uncertainty and rule:** does the interval support the minimum-saving claim?
4. **Data quality:** who was followed up, and how were outcomes measured?
5. **Economic inputs:** what was spent, when, by whom, and how long might savings last?

The city file has 10,000 businesses, including 4,794 participants. The separate pilot has 400 businesses in one district. This map identifies questions; it does not certify that the requirements hold.

Page 3 | Opening call and two priority requests

My opening decision

Sign / Sign with conditions / Request evidence
Claim and source: N___ / T9 row ___

Our two questions for the analyst

For each question: **what should the analyst send, what would it test, and how would the answer change our action?**

Priority 1 — evidence or document requested:

Claim tested and if/then consequence:

Priority 2 — evidence or document requested:

Claim tested and if/then consequence:

Spokesperson: _____ Listener/source checker: _____

"Is it robust?" is too vague. An analyst should know what to send and why it matters to the director's decision.

Page 4 | What did the analyst actually answer?

Log two substantial exchanges, including another group's question. A missing document is an honest answer, but it may leave the decision gap open.

Exchange 1

Question asked: _____
Answer and source ID: E___ / N___ / T9

Supported / Partial / Unanswered — why?

Useful follow-up or action:

Exchange 2

Question asked: _____
Answer and source ID: E___ / N___ / T9

Supported / Partial / Unanswered — why?

Useful follow-up or action:

Rate the answer against the specific question. Supported evidence can have a limited scope; "not supplied" must not be filled with invented assurance.

Page 5 | Advice to the director

Work alone. Compare your answer with your opening decision on page 3.

1. Action: sign, sign with conditions, or request evidence.

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2. Basis: cite one source and say precisely what it establishes.

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3. Boundary: what does that source not establish for national expansion?

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4. Next step: name one document/result and explain what you would do if it supports or challenges the claim.

My decision changed / stayed the same because:

A conditional next phase or a request for evidence can both be defensible. The quality of the reasoning matters more than which option was selected.